

2027 Student Device Refresh

One-page leadership brief for Superintendent's Cabinet

Prepared by
Chief Technology Officer

Date
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Decision requested
Authorize procurement planning for the 2027 refresh.

Recommendation

Replace approximately **2,600 student devices** reaching the district support threshold in summer 2027 and begin a rolling five-year refresh schedule. Planning estimate: **\$1.56 million**.

Why This Is Necessary

Ardent ISD supports approximately 8,400 students across 11 campuses. A large share of the fleet was acquired during 2020-2022 and now shows higher repair demand, battery degradation, and slower performance than newer devices.

Indicator	Evidence
Devices aging out	2,600 by Aug. 2027
Repair demand	31% above fleet average
Batteries below threshold	18% of sample
Testing concerns	7 of 11 campuses

If We Do Nothing

- Repair and battery failures will continue to rise.
- Unplanned mid-year purchases may occur at less favorable pricing.
- Assessment and digital curriculum access becomes less predictable.
- IT time shifts from lifecycle work to break/fix response.
- Equipment-age inequities grow across campuses.

Proposed Approach

Validate final inventory by December 2026; complete procurement during the winter window; receive and stage devices in spring/summer 2027; deploy before the first instructional day; retire and dispose of replaced units using district procedures.

Planning Cost

Cost Component	Estimate
2,600 devices @ avg. \$540	\$1,404,000
Cases, adapters, spares	\$78,000
Deployment / asset materials	\$18,000
Contingency	\$60,000
Total	\$1,560,000

Success Measures

- 100% deployed before the first instructional day.
- 100% recorded in asset management before campus delivery.
- Less than 2% day-one deployment defects.
- At least 95% of replaced equipment removed from active inventory within 45 days.
- Aging-device hardware tickets decline at least 25% in semester one.
- A funded five-year replacement forecast enters the 2027-28 budget.

Decision Requested

Authorize Technology to finalize specifications, coordinate procurement with Finance, and return with final pricing and award recommendation before purchase.